

Technical Document #494: Natural Language Processing - Comprehensive Overview

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Question answering systems extract answers from a given context. They typically consist of a retriever component and a reader component.

Machine translation converts text from one language to another. Neural machine translation using encoder-decoder architectures has achieved human-level performance.

Tokenization is the process of breaking text into individual units called tokens. Subword tokenization methods like BPE handle out-of-vocabulary words gracefully.

Word embeddings represent words as dense vectors in continuous space. Word2Vec, GloVe, and FastText are popular word embedding techniques.

Sentiment analysis determines the emotional tone behind a body of text. It is widely used in social media monitoring and customer feedback analysis.

Language models predict the probability of a sequence of words. Large language models like GPT and BERT have achieved remarkable performance on various NLP tasks.

Bioinformatics applies computational methods to analyze biological data. It has accelerated drug discovery and our understanding of genetic diseases.

Robotics combines mechanical engineering, electrical engineering, and computer science. Modern robots can perform complex tasks in unstructured environments.

Sustainability and environmental responsibility are becoming key considerations in technology design. Green computing aims to reduce the environmental impact of technology.

Quantum computing promises to solve problems that are intractable for classical computers. It has potential applications in cryptography, drug discovery, and optimization.

Computer vision applications are becoming ubiquitous, from facial recognition to autonomous driving. Deep learning has enabled breakthroughs in visual understanding.

Key Takeaways:

- Coreference resolution identifies all expressions that refer to the same entity in a text.
- Named entity recognition (NER) identifies and classifies named entities in text into predefined categories such as person names.
- Machine translation converts text from one language to another.